Corridor (Kharagpur-Vijayawada) and Southern Corridor (Goa-Chennai). A pre-feasibility study of the Chennai-Bangalore Freight Corridor is also being proposed.

PPP: NEW STEPS

The GOI is promoting PPPs as 'an effective tool for bringing private-sector efficiencies in creation of economic and social infrastructure assets' and for 'delivery of quality public services'. India in recent years has emerged as one of the *leading PPP markets in the world*, because of several policy and institutional initiatives. By end ***December 2012*** there were over 900 PPP projects in the infrastructure sector with total project cost (TPC) of Rs. 5,43,045 crore as compared to over 600 projects with TPC of Rs. 333,083 crore on 31 March 2010. These projects are at different stages of implementation, i.e. bidding, construction, and operational.

Approval of Central-sector PPP Projects: Since its constitution in January 2006, the Public Private Partnership Appraisal Committee (PPPAC) has approved 307 central project proposals with TPC of Rs. 2,97,856.58 crore. These include NHs (242 proposals), ports (29 proposals), airports (2 proposals), tourism infrastructure (1proposal), railways (1 proposal), housing (27 proposals), and sports stadia (5 proposals).

VGF for PPP Projects: Under the Scheme for Financial Support to PPPs in Infrastructure (Viability Gap Funding Scheme), 145 projects have been granted approval. Thirteen new sub-sectors have been included in the list of sectors eligible for VGF support under the Scheme which are –

i. Capital investment in the creation of modern storage capacity including cold chains and post-harvest storage.
ii. Education, health, and skill development.
iii. Internal infrastructure in National Investment and Manufacturing Zones.
iv. Oil/gas/liquefied natural gas (LNG) storage facility [includes City Gas distribution (CGD) network]; oil and gas pipelines (includes CGD network); irrigation (dams, channels, embankments, etc); telecommunication (fixed network) (includes optic fibre/ wire/cable